

1. datasette-agent-edit 0.1a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-07T23:56:38+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/7/datasette-agent-edit/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-agent-edit 0.1a0 I'm planning several plugins for Datasette Agent which can make edits to existing pieces of text - things like collaborative Markdown editing, updating large SQL queries, and editing SVG files. Agentic editing of text is a little tricky to get right. My favorite published design for this is for the Claude text editor , which implements the following tools: view - view sections of a file, with line numbers added to every line. str_replace - find an exact old_str and replace it with new_str - fail if the original string is not unique insert - insert the specified text after the specified line number Rather than recreate these patterns for every plugin that needs them I decided to create this base plugin, datasette-agent-edit , which implements the core tools in a way that allows them to be adapted for other plugins. Tags: ai , datasette , generative-ai , llms , llm-tool-use , datasette-agent

2. Doing nothing at work

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Mon, 08 Jun 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/doing-nothing-at-work/>

Many engineers should be doing less work. I don't necessarily mean producing less code or fewer changes, but literally working fewer hours in the day. When they do work, they should be working at a slower pace. I like to aim to be running at 80% utilization by default: unless I have a high-pressure project going on, I spend 20% of my workday away from the computer. High-impact opportunities Why? Performance at tech companies is dominated by outlier events . When I think about the most impactful changes I've made, many of them involved a surprisingly trivial amount of work. There are no points for effort in software development. What matters is solving the right problem at the right time. In large engineering organizations, there are usually trivial pieces of engineering work you could do that would make tens or hundreds of millions of dollars for the company. Here are three common examples: First, when the company is trying to sign a big enterprise deal, stepping in with a feature or bugfix can make the deal happen. It doesn't even have to be a good feature: sometimes just showing that you're willing and able to make a concrete change will be enough. Second, preventing or mitigati...

3. Mux ? Video for Developers

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-08T01:47:03Z

Link: https://www.mux.com/?utm_campaign=fireball&utm_source=DF

My thanks to Mux for sponsoring last week at DF. Mux is what developers reach for when they need to do more with video. Video files are packed with data and context waiting to be unlocked. Mux Robots are AI workflows that unlock that data inside your video for summarization, caption translation, moderation, and more. Configure once and your workflows run automatically on new uploads. Mux is video infrastructure trusted by Patreon, Substack, and Synthesia. Start building for free. Use code FIREBALL at signup for an extra \$50 credit. ?

4. ? SwiftUI Only Makes It Easy to Develop Bad Apps

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-08T01:30:00Z

Link: https://daringfireball.net/2026/06/swiftui_only_makes_it_easy_to_develop_bad_apps

Apple's developer message used to be that it was not just easy to develop apps for their platforms, but that it was easy to develop good idiomatically native apps. That's still true for AppKit and UIKit, but it's never been true for SwiftUI, and SwiftUI is now seven years old.

5. Alberto Romero on Apple's AI Spending

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-08T01:00:00Z

Link: <https://www.thealgorithmicbridge.com/p/what-apple-knows-about-ai-that-silicon>

Alberto Romero: AI is like religion. Either you believe it changes everything, or you don't

believe at all. There is no moderate position; nobody believes in AGI ?more or less,? just like nobody is ?casually religious.? If God exists, the only coherent response is to reorganize your entire life around that fact, as priests do. If you pray sometimes, then you are just an atheist who?s also fearful. When tech companies spend hundreds of billions on capital expenditures to add sparkly AI features to Office, Gmail, and Instagram, I only see fearful atheists ? guys who don?t believe in AI but pretend just in case. In 2026, the four largest cloud and AI infrastructure providers ? Amazon, Google, Meta, Microsoft ? committed to spending \$670 billion on CapEx . Apple, in contrast, spent \$12.7 billion on capex last fiscal year and projects \$14 billion for 2026 , 2% of what its peers are spending. The conventional reading in Silicon Valley is, naturally, that Apple is losing. Siri has been a punchline for years ? an internal executive called the delays ugly and embarrassing ? and critics say that Apple has not been the same without Steve Jobs. It is falling behind , they say, and moving way...

6. How to Talk to Your Coworkers

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Fri, 22 May 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/how-to-talk-to-your-coworkers>

You know you've explained the same issue before in two or three different places, yet here they are asking again. Why don't they understand you? Why do they ask the same question when you've already given them the answer right there on Jira? Are they stupid? Lazy, maybe? Do they not take the time to read? I often hear this from developers. They write clear documentation and instructions, and people still bother them to hop on a call. This happens so frequently that I think it is worth addressing. An over-abundance of information is just as confusing as too little. But something I should add is that repetition is normal. In fact, repetition should be a tool you use frequently. To do our jobs as developers, we read instructions. Our tasks are usually carefully written and specced out as a document we can implement and check off. There are usually bullet points, requirements, and acceptance criteria. Sometimes, you could implement a feature by following the instructions without even knowing or understanding what the feature actually does. In other jobs, non-technical people derive their work from conversation. A lossy format. For example, when a non-technical manager wants a new feat...

7. Don't call yourself a Software Engineer, and other Career Advice

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Mon, 18 May 2026 12:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/you-are-an-ai-enabled-engineer-now>

I can only imagine what it's like learning the skill of programming in this day and age. What does an average college class look like? What is the CS professor teaching? And students, how do you reconcile what you are learning vs the current job market? I know if I was a student today, I would at least attempt to make connections on LinkedIn to prepare for a future where I would need those connections to get a job . But LinkedIn is not a real place. It might have been at one point. But it certainly isn't today. Everybody is an AI Engineer/Leverager/Prompter/Professional. If I wasn't in the industry, it would be real confusing. I see my ex-colleagues right there on LinkedIn, gainfully employed, yet still felt the need to update their titles. We've worked together, I know their current role. Or at least I thought I knew. Now, that same role leverages AI in a way that has "enabled" them. The software engineers though, their role has remained the same while the entire marketing department has switched to AI first. The software engineer is being left behind . The whole company is moving fast, yet the person writing the code using Claude, Cursor, Codex, Copilot, that person remains a me...

8. In the Empire's Defense

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Sun, 17 May 2026 12:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/the-empire-won>

I didn't watch Star Wars when it was released. I wasn't even born. By the time we popped the

cassette tape in the VCR, it was at least 15 years old. But I liked the movie all the same. It was not my favorite film by any means, but it was memorable. The first time you see Darth Vader appear on screen, you know this villain is not going to be easy to defeat. "Villain" because no one needs to tell you who the good guys and bad guys are in this movie. The visuals, the voices, the music, everything tells you that Darth Vader and the Empire are up to no good. Now I get to watch the movie with my kids. I quickly pointed out to my sons that this is the bad guy. Stating the obvious. One of them asked, "Why is he the bad guy?" I had to pause for a second to come up with an explanation. I didn't have an answer. Instead I said, "Because he is mean as hell!" They fell asleep before the movie ended. I think they enjoyed it. But I really couldn't tell you exactly why Darth Vader was the bad guy. This is just a thought experiment, don't go telling the world that I am pro-Galactic Empire, OK? I'm not digging into the lore of Star Wars. I did that already with the Galactic Timezones piece and it wa...

9. 'Vim' has many faces

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-06-07T02:33:12Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/unix/VimManyFaces>

One of the problems I have when talking about 'vim' is that in practice, there are several versions of 'vim'. I don't mean 'version' in the sense of release numbers (although Vim has lots of releases and things change in them over time), but more in how people approach and use Vim. Even more than GNU Emacs, I feel that Vim has turned into an editor that has multiple faces, so the 'vim' that you use may not be the 'vim' that I use. (Which version or face of Vim you see depends in part on what your system decided to set as Vim defaults, unless you're advanced enough in Vim things to have a personal configuration that overrides them all.) I've seen people talk about at least three broad versions of Vim: The Vim with a bunch of plugins that is a full blown code editor or even IDE environment with LSP support (eg , also) and everything else you'd expect from such a thing. My impression is that this is surprisingly popular version of Vim, and I can see why; if you like the Vim editing style and find that LSP stuff fits into it for you, why not? The Vim with syntax highlighting, smart indentation (including language dependent things), and other features that you'd expect of a competent...

10. Aitken acceleration before Aitken

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 07 Jun 2026 20:14:45 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/07/aitkin-acceleration-kepler/>

Kepler solved his eponymous equation $M = E \cdot e \sin(E)$ by finding a fixed point of $E = M / e \sin(E)$. So guess a value of E and stick it into the right hand side. Then plug that value into the right hand side again. Kepler said a couple iterations should be enough. And a couple [?] The post Aitken acceleration before Aitken first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. The Laplace limit

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 07 Jun 2026 19:06:36 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/07/the-laplace-limit/>

An earlier post discussed how to solve Kepler's equation $M = E - e \sin(E)$ using a sine series. You could also solve Kepler's equation using a power series, which Lagrange did in 1771. Both approaches express E as a function of e and M , but from different perspectives. Bessel thought of his solution as a sum of sines in [?] The post The Laplace limit first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. A crank formula for ?

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sun, 07 Jun 2026 16:34:26 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/07/a-crank-formula-for-%cf%80/>

I ran across a cranky formula for π based on physical constants here and decided to play around with it. The source describes π as $\pi \approx \text{wavelength} \cdot \text{frequency}$ (chosen in the microwave region)? and I thought perhaps you could chose a value of frequency to make the equation work. But as a comment pointed out, the bracketed [?] The post A crank formula for π first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. Powering up a module from the IBM 604: an electronic calculator from 1948

Source: Ken Shirriff's blog | Published: 2026-06-07T09:57:09.956-07:00

Link: <http://www.righto.com/2026/06/ibm-604-thyratron-tube-module.html>

1948 was an interesting time for computing. For decades, businesses had used punch card equipment that added and sorted electromechanically. Now these electromechanical relays and counting wheels were being used to build room-filling general-purpose computers such as Harvard Mark I (1944) and IBM's SSEC (1948). But slow electromechanical mechanisms were already becoming obsolete. World War II had fostered the development of electronics and vacuum tubes for radio, radar, and navigation. Electronic technology was being used in massive electronic computers, such as Colossus (1943) and ENIAC (1946). The first stored-program computer, the Manchester Baby, was built in 1948. The IBM 604 Electronic Calculating Punch behind a Type 521 Card Reader/Punch. Photo from IBM. Note the panels in the side of the 604 and in the front of the 521 to hold plugboards. In the midst of these technological advances, IBM introduced the Electronic Calculating Punch, type 604. 1 This system may seem like a step backward: it wasn't a computer, but a programmable calculator that performed a fixed set of operations. 2 However, it was much smaller 3 than a computer?about the size of a double refrigerator?and muc...

14. Arp 297:

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Sun, 07 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/astro/arp297/>

North is left. (mirrored). 13.5x8.5 arcmin (0.35 arcsec/pixel) dt {color: var(--em-color)}

Total exposure time: 410 * 30 seconds = 3.4 hours. (across 2 nights) Exposure used in stack:

329 * 30 seconds = 2.7 hours. Telescope: C9.25 (230mm, f/10, fl=2300mm) Camera: IMX533 (16mm

diagonal, square, color) Processing: (no software sharpening used) Calibration (dark + flat)

Stacking (average w/ rejection) White balance and background subtraction Asinh stretch Tone

curve Crop Center left : NGC 5754 (z=0.015) and 5752 (z=0.015), a pair of gravitationally

interacting spiral galaxies. Only the spiral pattern of NGC 5752 is visible. There is a tidal

tail extending upwards, but it's too dim to see in this image. Center right : NGC 5755

(z=0.033), an irregular barred spiral galaxy. Right : NGC 5753 (z=0.032), a flocculant spiral

(not elliptical) Another pair of interacting galaxies, but at a completely different redshift

than Arp 297. Cool. There's actually a third member of this group (z=0.032) behind NGC 5752...

although it looks like a bright blob in one of the arms: Top left : LEDA 2133199 (z=0.014) and

LEDA 2132969. Not much is known about these, and I can't see much either. Related: arp2...

15. Stairway to Heaven

Source: the singularity is nearer | Published: 2026-06-07T00:00:00-07:00

Link: <https://geohot.github.io//blog/jekyll/update/2026/06/07/stairway-to-heaven.html>

They are a highly sophisticated statistical model designed to mimic the distribution of programming. The output is broken, but in a way that's getting harder and harder to detect.

Which is exactly what you'd expect from an increasingly accurate statistical model. ? The

Eternal Sloptember 5 years ago, I would have laughed that idea out of the room. I fully

understand what's dumb about it. I don't believe in some stupid metaphysics where there can be

two things that have all the same testable properties but yet are somehow different . There is

only one electron. But the key phrase there is testable properties . Once you are optimizing

for those properties, they cease to be a good measure . In so much as you use statistics and

tests to classify things, the AI outputs will seem correct, and will pass more and more tests

as AI improves. However, they are just optimizing for the metrics harder; reward hacking. It's

not doing what you are doing. It's not an embodied agent refined by billions of years of

evolution trying to survive in a crazy complex uncertain world. It's a fancy autocomplete. I

read this post and it triggered me. It's basically about how brands sell you an identity and

i...

16. A new era for software testing

Source: antirez.com | Published: Sun, 07 Jun 2026 11:46:06 +0200

Link: <http://antirez.com/news/168>

Automatic programming dramatically speeds up writing software in certain use cases and in the right hands. In my experience the output does not reach the structural quality and economy of complexity of the best hand-written software. However, not all the software is stellar, and my feeling is that automatic programming surpasses most of the times (and if well managed) the quality of decently developed hand-written code. Yet, there is a tradeoff between quality and time, in the case of writing new software with AI. This tradeoff in certain projects I developed can be brutal, that is, completing projects that may take many months in a few weeks. However, there are domains where LLMs simply open new strictly more powerful ways to automate processes, without any compromise on quality. One of those domains is software QA and testing. Traditionally software is tested using test suites that are composed of locally-scoped tests and integration tests (think of Redis: one thing is testing if SET foo 10 will be matched by GET foo => 10, another thing is testing if replication works in this case). And then by QA passes that are usually manually executed, and that can capture holes in the runn...

17. Copping My Style

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-06-07T02:54:43Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17355475/adobe-creator-act-style-protection-commentary>

Can you legally protect an artistic style? Not currently, but an Adobe-backed bill, a seeming reaction to AI, is pitching the idea. Personally, I see a bunch of blurred lines.

18. Encrypting IP Addresses

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Sun, 07 May 2017 20:46:14 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/encrypting-ip-addresses/>

On IP address encryption: security analysis with respect for privacy Frequently, privacy concerns and regulations get in the way of security analysis. I'm a big fan of privacy, but I'm also a big fan of security and preventing people from getting hacked. If you are hacked you have no privacy either. Per-customer/subscriber traces are extremely useful for researching the security of networks. Specifically, lists of DNS requests per IP address make spotting infected users or infected devices very easy, especially if you look at yesterday's traffic? and compare it to today's threat intelligence.

19. On Linux Vdso and Clock_gettime

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Fri, 24 Mar 2017 20:22:18 +0200

Link: https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/on-linux-vdso-and-clock_gettime/

On Linux vDSO and clock_gettime sometimes being slow Like the previous post on this somewhat dormant blog, I want to share an oddity I discovered that no search engine could really find for me - even though once I found what the problem was, it turns out I was by no means the first person to discover this. Some system calls that are used extremely frequently in Linux can be speeded up by a mechanism called vDSO: a virtual dynamically linked shared object.

20. Optimizing optimizing: some insights that led to a 400% speedup of PowerDNS

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 22 Sep 2016 13:16:31 +0100

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/optimizing-optimizing-400-percent-speedup/>

So no matter how pretty your code, eventually someone will benchmark it and demand top performance. Squeezing microseconds is a very addictive and even destructive activity. It ruins your evenings, destroys your ability to converse with human beings and typically leaves your code in a mess. No programmer can escape it however: the world demands speed, or a somewhat equivalent modern measure, longer battery life. Squeezing out more performance is not just a matter of writing better code?.